

Acme Retail - Customer Refund Policy (v3.2, effective 2025-03-01)

1. Purpose

This policy defines how customer refund requests are reviewed, approved and recorded so that every customer receives a consistent outcome.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all refund requests for online orders handled by the Customer Support team. It does not apply to wholesale orders or to chargebacks raised by a bank.

3. Refund eligibility

A refund may be issued when the customer requests it within 30 days of delivery and provides the original order number or receipt.

4. Approval authority

Support agents may approve refunds of up to \$200 on their own authority.

Refunds above \$200 and up to \$1,000 must be approved by the Support Team Lead before payment.

Refunds above \$1,000 must be approved by the Customer Operations Manager, and Finance must be notified the same day.

5. Exceptions

If an item arrives damaged, the receipt requirement is waived when the customer supplies a photograph of the damage.

If a request shows signs of fraud, the agent must stop processing and escalate the case to the Risk team instead of refunding.

6. Records

For every refund the agent records the ticket ID, the reason code and the approver's name in the refund system within 24 hours.

7. Quality control

The QA team audits a random 5% sample of completed refunds each month and reports deviations to the Customer Operations Manager.